English Book III (Plays & Poems) — Class 11 — Solved Exercises (PCTB)

Play 1: Heat Lightning (Robert F. Carroll)

Exercise I: Choose the correct answer (Book pp. 11-12)

(i) The bus was late due to

(a) rush

✓ (b) storm

(c) accident

(d) change in schedule

(ii) The girl was coming from

✓ (a) the party

(b) tour

(c) a hill station

(d) a station

(iii) The girl was afraid of

(a) the policeman

(b) a friend

✓ (c) a killer

(d) a person

(iv) She thought of reaching the house but

(a) the car broke down

(b) the brakes failed

✓ (c) the car ran out of gas

(d) the road was blocked

(v) She saw the man dragging out of his car

✓ (a) the corpse of a woman

(b) a sack

(c) a statue

(d) a dog

(vi) Why did she circle, round and round into the wood?

✓ (a) to escape from the killer

(b) to reach a safe place

(c) to cheat a man

(d) to save herself

(vii) "You couldn't think of something that might give them a lead" means

(a) to find a culprit

(b) to find a treasure

(c) to persecute

✓ (d) to get a clue

(viii) She saw in the flash of lightning

(a) a dog

(b) a bus

(c) a car

✓ (d) a man's face

(ix) The difference in the ages of the two men is

(a) ten years

✓ (b) five years

(c) two years

(d) one year

(x) If people were smart they wouldn't be out

(a) on a day like this

(b) on a holiday

(c) on a tour

✓ (d) on a night like this

Exercise II: Mark the statements true / false (Book p. 12)

(1) The car ran out of gas about two miles from here. [False]

(2) She was too frightened to tell the details of the incident. [False]

(3) The Girl went to the police to report the matter. [False]

(4) Second Man wanted to save himself from the storm. [True]

(5) First Man wanted to go to town for business. [True]

(6) They heard the hum of a motor in the distance. [True]

(7) She could not remember the description of the killer. [True]

(8) She bolted the door before the man came near. [True]

Exercise III: Answer the following questions (Book p. 12)

(a) Why couldn't the Girl describe the killer?

The Girl could not describe the killer because she was too frightened and she had seen him only in flashes of lightning. She saw the woman's hand, head and long light hair being dragged in the mud, but she does not remember the man's face at all, nor whether he was wearing a hat. Fear had wiped out every detail of his appearance.

(b) What were the circumstances that forced her to leave her car?

The Girl had been at a party and thought she had enough gas to get home, eight miles away. About a mile from the bus station her car ran out of gas. There were very few cars at that hour of the morning, so she locked her car, took her flashlight and started walking down the road, hoping to catch the bus and return for the car later.

(c) Why did she ask for help from First Man?

She asked First Man for help because he was the only person in the bus station, and she was terrified and being chased by the killer. She rushed in sobbing, bolted the door and cried, "Thank God! You're here!" She believed that a fellow human being in the station would protect her from the man outside.

(d) What was the condition of the weather?

The weather was stormy. Heavy rain was falling, lightning flashed again

and again, and large bursts of thunder followed. The storm was so severe that the bus was late, the light in the station dimmed with every flash, and no one could travel safely on the road.

(e) How did Second Man accuse First Man of lying?

Second Man accused First Man of lying because, when he looked in through the glass door, he had seen somebody else in the room. First Man had tried to suggest that there was no one else there. Second Man said plainly, "You tried to tell me there was no one else here. What was the idea of lying?"

(f) Does the Girl become suspicious of First Man as the play progresses?

At first the Girl trusts First Man completely as her helper and protector. She does not suspect him at all while he comforts her and questions her. Her trust turns to horror only at the very end, when he takes out a flashlight from his coat pocket — her own flashlight, which she had dropped while running from the killer. Then she realizes that he himself is the killer.

(g) What is her impression about Second Man?

At first the Girl is terrified of Second Man, because his face pressed against the glass in a flash of lightning seems to be the killer's face. Then she finds him rough and forward: he grabs her arm, insists that she should go with him, and laughs at her fear. In the end she realizes that he was not the killer at all, only a traveller who wanted shelter from the storm.

(h) Why didn't she accompany Second Man?

She did not accompany Second Man because his manner frightened her and she trusted First Man more. Second Man grabbed her arm and said, "We'll have it all to ourselves," which alarmed her. She refused firmly, saying, "No — No — I won't. Leave me alone. I'm going to stay here — with him."

Exercise IV: Answer the following questions in 100-150 words (Book p. 12)

(a) Write down the story of the play in your own words.

On a stormy night a young Girl of about twenty-three rushes into a lonely bus station on a deserted highway. Her car has run out of gas, and while walking she saw a man dragging a woman's corpse out of a car in the lightning. She fled through the woods and reached the station, where a pleasant Man of about thirty-five comforts her and advises her to go to the police, though she cannot describe the killer. A Second Man then forces his way in from the storm, and the Girl fears he is the killer. But the Second Man is only a traveller, and he leaves laughing. When the Girl and the First Man are alone again, the Man takes out a flashlight — the Girl's own flashlight, which she dropped while running. She realizes with horror that he is the killer. She bolts the door, and a dog that has come in from the storm jumps and seizes the Man with its sharp teeth, forcing him to run away. The Girl is saved.

(b) Have you had any experience of a similar situation? Write at least ten sentences.

No, I have never faced a situation as frightening as the Girl's, and I hope I

never do. Once, however, I was caught in a heavy storm on my way home from school, and for a few minutes I felt something of her fear. The rain was pouring, the lightning flashed, and the road was almost empty. I ran to the nearest shop and waited there until the storm passed. The shopkeeper comforted me and gave me a glass of water, just as the First Man comforted the Girl. That day I learned how important it is to stay calm in danger and to seek help from people nearby. I also learned that one should never travel alone late at night on a deserted road. If I ever saw a crime, I would at once inform the police, because it is our duty. The play teaches us that presence of mind and courage can save a person even in great danger.

(c) Why did the Girl consider First Man her helper?

The Girl considered First Man her helper because he was the only person in the station when she rushed in, terrified and pursued. He caught her as she almost fell, calmed her, gave her a seat, and listened to her story with sympathy. He protected her by hiding her in the Women's room when the Second Man rattled the door, and he refused to go away with the Second Man. He advised her to go to the police and assured her that she would be safe. His gentle, fatherly manner made her trust him completely. She had no reason to suspect that the kind man comforting her was the very killer she was running from, and that is the tragic irony of the play.

(d) What are the factors that played a role in saving the Girl?

Several factors played a role in saving the Girl. First, she outran the killer and lost him by circling round and round in the woods, so that she reached the bus station alive. Second, the bolted door of the station kept

the killer out for a time. Third, she refused to accompany the Second Man, whose rough manner frightened her, and chose to stay where she felt safer. Fourth, her own memory returned at the crucial moment: when the First Man produced her flashlight, she recognized him as the killer and bolted the door before he could reach her. Finally, a dog that had come into the station to save itself from the storm jumped and seized the Man with its sharp teeth, forcing him to run away. Thus her courage, her quick action and a lucky chance together saved her life.

(e) How did she realize the truth?

She realized the truth when the First Man took out a flashlight from his coat pocket. It was her own flashlight, which she had dropped on the road while running away from the killer. Only the killer could have picked it up where she dropped it. The Man had been questioning her again and again about what she had seen, and now his possession of her flashlight proved that he was the man by the car. In horror she cried out, ran to the Centre door and bolted it before he could come near her. Then the dog attacked him, and she was saved. The flashlight, a small everyday object, became the clue that exposed the murderer.

Exercise V: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 12)

i want to get out of this storm what the hell do you think i want what s the idea of locking this door you think you own this place

"I want to get out of this storm. What the hell do you think I want? What's the idea of locking this door? You think you own this place?"

Exercise VI: Fill in the blanks using a preposition given in bracket (Book p. 12)

(1) She sobs and rushes ___ the Man quickly. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

to

(2) He brings her ___ to the bench. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

down

(3) I could get the bus when it came ___. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

along

(4) I run like crazy all ___ the road. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

over

(5) I'm sure you can answer most ___ them. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

of

(6) I saw somebody else when I looked ___. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

in

(7) You'll never get over being afraid ___ things. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

of

(8) The dog jumps and seizes the Man ___ its sharp teeth. (to, down, along, of, over, in, with)

with

Play 2: Visit to a Small Planet (Gore Vidal)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book pp. 28-29)

(i) Who is Roger Spelding?

(a) a general

(b) a soldier

✓ (c) a newscaster

(d) a technician

(ii) John is a

(a) merchant

✓ (b) farm owner

(c) pilot

(d) professor

(iii) Where did the spaceship land?

(a) on the roof of a building

(b) in the fields

(c) on a hill

✓ (d) in the rose garden of Mrs. Spelding

(iv) Ellen listened to the broadcast of her

✓ (a) daddy

(b) fiance

(c) mother

(d) Kreton

(v) The visitor was dressed in the fashion of

(a) 1960

✓ (b) 1860

(c) 1900

(d) 1850

(vi) What is the impression of Kreton on seeing the inside of the house?

(a) disgusted

✓ (b) delightful

(c) callous

(d) sorrowful

(vii) "I do hope I don't sound patronizing" means that I am

(a) not praising

✓ (b) encouraging

(c) discouraging

(d) not appreciating

(viii) How many years are required to tell the story of travel?

(a) one hundred

(b) two hundred

✓ (c) five hundred

(d) seven hundred

(ix) The house of Spelding comes under the

(a) civil law

(b) criminal law

(c) company law

✓ (d) martial law

(x) General Powers was thinking about

(a) his promotion

✓ (b) security of the country

(c) arrest of Kreton

(d) murder of the visitor

Exercise 2: Mark the statements true or false (Book p. 29)

(i) Ellen is going to marry John, a farm boy. [True]

(ii) A girl should prefer to marry a hardworking and ambitious boy. [True]

(iii) The space man looked like a monster. [False]

(iv) Kreton cannot read the minds of the people. [False]

(v) Kreton is interested in the study of the civilization of earth. [True]

(vi) There are no instruments in the flying saucer. [True]

(vii) Mrs. Spelding is worried about her rose garden. [True]

(viii) Kreton gives his consent to spend the night. [True]

(ix) General Powers thinks that Kreton is a spy. [True]

(x) The race of Kreton is violent like the human race. [False]

Exercise 3: Answer the following questions (Book p. 30)

(i) How does Kreton prove his extraordinary powers? Write five sentences.

Kreton proves his extraordinary powers in several ways. First, he hears what is inside people's minds: he tells General Powers exactly what he is thinking, that he dreams of three silver stars on his shoulder instead of two, that is, of his promotion. Second, he speaks all the languages of the Earth. Third, his spaceship has no instruments, no food and nothing inside, yet it travels between dimensions. Fourth, he puts an invisible wall around his ship, so that the soldiers cannot get near it. Fifth, when Powers and his AIDE rush at him, they stop stunned within a foot of him, because no one can touch him.

(ii) What is the purpose of Kreton's visit?

The purpose of Kreton's visit is simply a visit to our small planet. He has been studying the Earth for years as a hobby, especially this period of its

development, when human civilization is only in its initial stages. In the end he reveals a further purpose: he has come to take charge of the whole world, because he believes people will be much happier under his rule.

(iii) How much advanced is the civilization of Kreton than that of the Earth?

The civilization of Kreton is far more advanced than that of the Earth. His people started visiting the Earth long before there were people on this planet. They travel casually between dimensions, they do not die, they control their thoughts, and they see everything through special monitors without travelling. By contrast, human civilization is only in its initial stages: Kreton says that men would need another five hundred years even to understand his explanation of space travel, and about two thousand years to understand time.

(iv) Can the people of the Earth compete with those of Kreton?

No, the people of the Earth cannot compete with those of Kreton. Human power — troops, martial law, weapons and suspicion — is helpless against him. General Powers surrounds the house with soldiers and declares martial law, yet he cannot touch Kreton, cannot enter his ship, and cannot stop him from reading his mind. Kreton's people have conquered death itself, while men are, in his words, poor fragile butterflies with brief little moments in the sun. The two civilizations are not on the same level at all.

(v) How damaging is violence in life? Write five sentences.

Violence is very damaging in life. First, it breeds fear and hatred between

people and nations, and destroys peace of mind. Second, it wastes the wealth of nations on armies, weapons and martial law instead of schools, health and progress. Third, it corrupts judgment: General Powers suspects every stranger of being a spy sent before an invasion. Fourth, it destroys innocent things, like Mrs. Spelding's rose garden and the peace of a happy home. Fifth, it keeps humanity in a primitive stage, because a violent race cannot rise to the higher civilization that Kreton's people have reached.

(vi) What type of life do you foresee in the year 5000?

In the year 5000, I foresee a life free from hatred and violence, as the theme of the play suggests. Men will have conquered disease and perhaps even death, and will travel easily between the planets. There will be no armies and no martial law, because nations will have learned to live in peace. People will feel pride in the service of humanity rather than in power over others. Science will have explained time and space, and human beings will control their thoughts and emotions as Kreton's people do. Life will be happier, longer and nobler than it is today.

(vii) How impressive were the morals of Kreton?

The morals of Kreton are very impressive. He is gentle, honest, humorous and peace-loving: he never dreams of invading the Earth, and he assures General Powers that none of his people would dream of it. He loves human beings as a hobby and approves of everything they do, even their primitive ways. He is kind to the Spelding family and polite to everyone. At the same time he is playful and a little arrogant in his superiority, and his final announcement that he will take charge of the world shows that even a highly moral being can be tempted by power.

(viii) What is the role of General Powers in the play?

General Powers plays the role of the military mind and of human suspicion. He surrounds the Spelding house with troops, declares martial law, cuts off the telephone, and interrogates Kreton for two hours, because his job is to guard the security of the country. He suspects Kreton of being a spy sent before an invasion, and he wants to take the spaceship apart for military use. His complete failure — he cannot touch Kreton or enter the ship — proves that human military power is helpless before a superior civilization. He is also a comic figure, dreaming of his promotion to three stars.

(ix) What is the theme of Kreton's study?

The theme of Kreton's study is the Earth and its people in their present, primitive stage of development. He has studied the planet for years, especially this period when human civilization is only beginning. He is fascinated by the rawness of human emotions, by the fact that men do not control their thoughts, and by their violence, suspicion and pride. He studies them as a hobby, the way a human being might study an interesting but backward tribe. His study leads him to the conclusion that human beings are still children in the story of civilization.

(x) How does Kreton impress General Powers?

Kreton impresses General Powers by powers that no soldier can match. He tells Powers his secret thought — that he dreams of three silver stars, that is, of his promotion — and Powers is startled to find him correct. He shows a spaceship with no instruments that still travels between dimensions. He puts an invisible wall around the ship, so that the soldiers cannot approach it. Finally, when Powers orders his AIDE to grab Kreton,

both men stop stunned within a foot of him, because no one can touch him. Powers, who began by calling him a monster and a spy, ends helpless and amazed.

Exercise 4: Answer the following questions in 100-150 words (Book p. 30)

(i) Write a note on: (a) Mr. Spelding (b) Mrs. Spelding (c) Ellen (d) John (e) General Powers (f) Kreton.

(a) Mr. Spelding (Roger Spelding) is a middle-aged TV newscaster, known as 'Father America', unctuous and resonant in manner. He is proud, self-important and fond of his broadcasts, and he dreams of being the first journalist to interview Kreton. As a father he wants Ellen to marry a hard-working, ambitious man who will make his mark, not a farm boy. (b) Mrs. Spelding is his bored, vague wife, who knits passively and worries most about her rose garden, which the spaceship has damaged. She finds Kreton comforting, like Grandfather Spelding, because of his whiskers. (c) Ellen, a lively girl of twenty, is engaged to John. She is kind, curious and fascinated by Kreton, and she hopes he will stay with the family. (d) John Randolph is Ellen's fiance, a farm boy who grows English walnuts on his own farm. He is brave — he runs toward the landing spaceship — and simple and honest. (e) General Powers is a vigorous National Guard general, obsessed with security, who declares martial law and suspects Kreton of spying. (f) Kreton is a mild, pleasant man in his forties, dressed in the fashion of 1860, with side-whiskers. He reads minds, speaks all languages, never dies, and ends by announcing that he will take charge of the whole world.

(ii) How does the playwright expose the inferiority of the present race to that of the future?

The playwright exposes the inferiority of the present race through a constant contrast between Kreton and the human beings. Kreton's people travel between dimensions, read minds, speak all languages, put invisible walls around their ships, and do not die; human beings need troops, martial law, telephones and weapons, and all of these fail. Kreton tells them plainly that they are only in the initial stages of civilization, that they would need five hundred years to understand his explanation and two thousand years to understand time. Human suspicion is shown as primitive: Powers at once thinks of spies and invasion, while Kreton's people have never dreamed of invading anyone. Even human pride is childish beside Kreton's calm superiority. The play thus makes the audience feel how backward, violent and fearful the present race still is, and how far it has to travel toward the peaceful, rational civilization of the future.

(iii) Describe the arrival of the flying saucer in your own words.

On a starry night a luminous object arcs slowly across the sky and comes down toward the Spelding house in Silver Glen, Maryland. John rushes in shouting that it is coming this way and will land right there. The family watches from the house as the shining object, not much larger than a car, lands right in Mrs. Spelding's rose garden. Its whole side opens, and a man steps out — mild and pleasant looking, in his forties, with side-whiskers and dressed in the fashion of 1860. John shakes hands with him and brings him up to the house. Meanwhile Mr. Spelding telephones General Powers, who arrives with troops, surrounds the house and declares martial law. The visitor introduces himself as Kreton, from

another planet in another dimension, come simply to visit this small planet which he has studied for years as a hobby.

(iv) Compare and contrast the people of the two planets.

The people of Kreton's planet and the people of the Earth are sharply different. Kreton's people are peaceful: they have never dreamed of invading anyone, they do not trade, and they do not die. They travel between dimensions, read minds, speak all languages, and see everything through monitors without travelling. They control their thoughts, while human thoughts run wild with raw, uncontrolled emotions. Earth people, by contrast, are violent and suspicious: they keep armies, declare martial law, suspect every stranger of spying, and fight over things they do not have. They are short-lived — poor fragile butterflies, as Kreton calls them — and their civilization is only in its initial stages. Yet both peoples share curiosity, pride and love of family: the Speldings are warm and hospitable, and Kreton himself loves human beings as a hobby. The difference is not in worth but in age: one race is grown up, the other is still a child.

(v) Write a story of your visit to a far off place in the north of Pakistan.

Last summer I visited Hunza, a far-off valley in the north of Pakistan, and the journey itself was an adventure. We travelled by bus along the Karakoram Highway, past deep ravines, roaring rivers and snow-capped peaks, until we reached Karimabad, the main town of Hunza. The valley was green and peaceful, with apricot orchards, poplar trees and old forts — Baltit Fort and Altit Fort — standing on the hillsides. The people were kind and hospitable; they offered us dried apricots and butter tea, and the children showed us the way to the Attabad Lake, whose blue water

shines between the mountains. We visited the Passu Cones, the white peaks that look like a row of sharp teeth, and we watched the sunset over Rakaposhi. At night the sky was full of stars, clearer than I had ever seen. I returned home with the feeling that the north of Pakistan is one of the most beautiful places on Earth, and that its people, like the Speldings, are simple, brave and warm-hearted.

Exercise 5: Fill in the blanks (Book pp. 30-31)

(i) It's not very flattering when one's own daughter won't listen ___ what one says. (for, to)

to

(ii) He doesn't want to get ___. (up, setup)

up

(iii) There is nothing wrong ___ marrying a wealthy man. (with, for)

with

(iv) There is something wrong ___ the way that creature looks. (without, with)

with

(v) I'm sure you're teasing us and this is ___ some kind of publicity stunt. (none, all)

all

(vi) You'd be surprised what a ___ study I've made. (thorough, through)

thorough

(vii) As you see I am ___ a hundred years too late. (above, about)

about

(viii) It's possible that I could explain it to a mathematician but I'm afraid I couldn't explain it ___ you. (about, to)

to

(ix) I must've known the theory ___ which they operate. (on, at)

on

(x) I wonder how ___ damage he did to my rose garden. (many, much)

much

Exercise 6: Use the following phrasal verbs in your own sentences (Book p. 31)

Use 'pass on' in a sentence of your own.

The old teacher passed on his love of books to his students.

Use 'pass through' in a sentence of your own.

We passed through the small town on our way to the mountains.

Use 'pass over' in a sentence of your own.

The committee passed over his application without any discussion.

Use 'pass down' in a sentence of your own.

This old watch has been passed down in our family for three generations.

Exercise 7: Punctuate the following lines (Book p. 31)

the odds against being hit by a falling object that size are i should say roughly ten million to one

"The odds against being hit by a falling object that size are, I should say, roughly, ten million to one."

Play 3: The Oyster and the Pearl (William Saroyan)

Exercise I: Write short answers to these questions (Book pp. 52-53)

(1) Where does the play take place?

The play takes place in Harry Van Dusen's barber shop in O.K.-by-the-Sea, California, a small town with a population of 909. The sea is a block down the street, and the shop is crowded with odds and ends washed up by the sea.

(2) Why is Harry sitting in the barber's chair?

Harry is sitting in the barber's chair because Clay Larrabee, a boy of nine or ten, is giving him a haircut. Harry and Clay exchange haircuts free of charge: Harry gives Clay a haircut free, and Clay gives Harry one free.

That is why, at the opening of the play, the barber himself is in the chair.

(3) According to Harry, how does one bring merriment to the tired old human heart?

According to Harry, one brings merriment to the tired old human heart by composing a symphony, painting a picture, writing a book, or inventing a philosophy. He tells Clay that such a person may be the one man hidden away in the junk of the world who brings joy to tired hearts.

(4) What is Harry's philosophy?

Harry's philosophy is the 'Take-it-easy' way — a way to live. It means relaxing, taking one's time, enjoying the sea, fishing, reading and laughter, instead of hurrying and worrying. Harry admits that the trouble with his philosophy was that he kept forgetting to take it easy, until he came to O.K.-by-the-Sea and found the proper place to stop.

(5) How much did Harry pay for his barber shop? How long has he been in O.K.-by-the-Sea?

Harry paid seventy-five dollars for his barber shop. He had eighty dollars to his name, and the old barber sold him the shop for seventy-five and threw in the haircut. He has been in O.K.-by-the-Sea for twenty-four years.

(6) How many barbers are there in O.K.-by-the-Sea?

There is only one barber in O.K.-by-the-Sea, and that is Harry Van Dusen himself. He says plainly, 'Nobody would [get a haircut], since I'm the only barber.'

(7) How much does Harry charge for a haircut?

The regular price of a haircut is a dollar, but Harry says it is too much for a haircut, so he generally takes a half or a quarter. He adds, 'Now and then I do. Now and then I don't,' because most of the people of the town are too poor to pay even that.

(8) Where is Clay going?

Clay is going down to the beach to look for stuff washed up by the sea. He says, 'This time I'm going to find something real good, I think.'

(9) Why does Clay need money?

Clay needs money for two reasons: he wants to get his father to come home again, and he wants to buy his mother a present. The family is living off the money they saved from the summer they worked, and there is not much left.

(10) What has happened to Clay's father?

Clay's father, Clark Larrabee, picked up and went off the day after Clay's last haircut, about a month ago. All he said was 'Enough's enough,' which he wrote on the kitchen wall. The family thought he would be back in a day or two, but he did not return, and now they have to find him and bring him back.

(11) What does Clay want to put in the local newspaper?

Clay wants to put an advertisement in the local newspaper, The O.K.-by-the-Sea Gull, which comes out every Saturday. The ad says: 'Clark Larrabee. Come home. Your fishing tackle's in the closet safe and sound. The fishing's good, plenty of cabazon, perch, and bass. Let

bygones be bygones. We miss you. Mama, Clay, Roxanna, Rufus, Clara.'

(12) Who is Miss McCutcheon? How does she feel about her job?

Miss McCutcheon (Vivian McCutcheon) is the new teacher at the school in O.K.-by-the-Sea, in town since last Sunday. One week at the school has knocked her for a loop: she wants to quit and go home to San Francisco, yet at the same time she has a feeling she ought to stay. She asks Harry's advice: 'Shall I go, or shall I stay?'

(13) What is Miss McCutcheon looking for? How does she feel about the children of the town?

Miss McCutcheon is looking for a chance to teach — not for a husband, as Harry teases her; she expects a husband to look for her. About the children she feels despair: they do not care about anything, whether they get good grades or bad, whether they pass or fail, or anything else. Almost all of them are unruly, and the only things they seem interested in are games and the sea. Nobody seems to have any sensible ambition; it is all fun and play. That is why she is on her way to the beach on a Saturday, to watch them and understand them better.

(14) What does Harry advise her to do?

Harry advises her to go back to San Francisco while the going's good. He says, 'You're too good for a town like this. Too young and too intelligent.' He means that a clever, serious young teacher will only be disappointed in a town where nobody cares for learning.

(15) What kind of haircut does Miss McCutcheon want?

Miss McCutcheon wants a poodle haircut.

(16) Can Harry give a poodle haircut?

No, Harry cannot give a poodle haircut. He does not know how to give one, and even if he knew how, he would not do it. He does not give women haircuts at all: the only women who visit his shop bring their small children for haircuts. He tells her, 'In my sleep, in a nightmare, I would not cut your hair.'

(17) What does Miss McCutcheon think that a poodle haircut will do for her appearance?

Miss McCutcheon thinks that a poodle haircut will make her look more plain and simple, so that she fits into the scenery around her. She has decided to stay, and she believes that changing her appearance — and dressing differently too — will make the children take her seriously, instead of thinking her nothing more than a pretty girl who is going to give up and go home in despair.

(18) Where has Clark Larrabee been? How did he get to O.K.-by-the-Sea?

Clark Larrabee has been working in Salinas. He got to O.K.-by-the-Sea by getting a ride down in a truck, which is now across the street at the gasoline station. He is only passing through, hoping to run into Clay, and he has not been home at all: he has left his wife Fay.

(19) What does Clark give Harry? For what purpose?

Clark gives Harry three ten-dollar bills — thirty dollars — and asks him not to tell Clay who gave the money. The purpose is that Clay should take the money home to his mother. It is the first money Clark has been able to save, and he hopes that when he makes some more, he will send it to Harry to hand to Clay to take home.

(20) How far is it to Hollywood from O.K.-by-the-Sea?

It is about two hundred miles straight down the highway from O.K.-by-the-Sea to Hollywood. Harry tells the writer, 'About two hundred straight down the highway. You can't miss it.'

(21) What work does the Man do?

The Man is a writer. He writes 'a little bit of everything.' He is on his way to Hollywood, and he has stopped in O.K.-by-the-Sea while they change the oil in his car across the street, to get a haircut and get it out of the way.

(22) What did Clay find near Black Rock?

Near Black Rock, Clay found an oyster. The tide hardly ever gets low enough for a fellow to get around to the ocean side of Black Rock, but a little while ago it did, so Clay went around there, poked about, and found the oyster. He did not happen to find it; he went looking for it.

(23) What does Clay believe is in the oyster? How much is it worth?

Clay believes that there is a big pearl in the oyster. The oyster is shut tight and alive, and Clay says the pearl in it is worth at least three hundred dollars.

(24) Does Miss McCutcheon believe that there is a pearl in the oyster?

No, Miss McCutcheon does not believe that there is a pearl in the oyster. She says the truth is that there is no pearl in it: only one oyster in a million has a pearl, so truth favors the probability that this is not the millionth oyster. She wants to open the oyster and show the children that there is no pearl in it, so that Clay will begin to face reality.

(25) Why does Miss McCutcheon have a chair with three legs?

Miss McCutcheon is carrying a cane chair without one leg and without a seat, which she picked up at the beach. That is why it has only three legs. Like everybody else in the town — the children, Judge Applegarth, Fenton Lockhart and Harry himself — she has begun bringing things home from the sea.

(26) What kind of judge is Judge Applegarth?

Judge Applegarth is not a real judge at all. He judged animals — hounds, or dogs — at a county fair one time, so the town calls him Judge. Nobody ever checked up on it; he said he did it, and that certainly entitled him to be called Judge Applegarth.

(27) What year is it?

It is 1953. When Miss McCutcheon asks, 'Are we living in the Middle Ages, Mr. Van Dusen?' Greeley answers, 'No, this is 1953, Miss McCutcheon.'

(28) What does Greeley have in a bottle?

Greeley has sea water in a bottle. He insists that there are little living things in the water, which cannot be seen now but will show up later, because the water of the sea is full of things.

(29) Who suggests that they should open the oyster?

Miss McCutcheon suggests that they should open the oyster. She says to Harry, 'Mr. Van Dusen, shall we open the oyster and show Clay and his sister Roxanna and their friend Greeley that there is no pearl in it?'

(30) Why do they want Wozzeck to come?

They want Wozzeck to come because Harry would rather have Wozzeck open the oyster than open it himself: 'I'd rather he opened this oyster. I might damage the pearl.' Wozzeck repairs watches, radios and alarm clocks and sells jewelry, so he is the expert for the job. Secretly, Harry also plans that Wozzeck, who has a few pretty good-sized cultivated pearls, will pretend to find a pearl in the oyster, so that Clay gets his three hundred dollars.

(31) How does Harry describe the inhabitants of O.K.-by-the-Sea?

Harry describes the inhabitants of O.K.-by-the-Sea as all poor. Most of them cannot afford to pay for the haircuts he gives them. A few find jobs for a couple of months every year, North or South, come back half dead of homesickness, and live on next to nothing the rest of the year. A few get pensions. Every family has a garden and a few chickens, and they make a few dollars selling vegetables and eggs. In a town of almost a thousand people there is not one rich man, not even one who is well off. 'And yet,' Harry says, 'these people are the richest I have ever known.'

(32) How does Miss McCutcheon view Harry's thinking about the pearl in the oyster?

At first Miss McCutcheon strongly opposes Harry's thinking: she calls it a trick and his 'mumbo-jumbo ideas,' and asks whether he plans to put pearls in oysters for every poor child in the world. But in the end she gives in and asks what he wants her to do. She agrees to be just a little less sure about things when she talks to the troubled children, and to let Clay come around to the truth easily enough as soon as he gets his father home.

(33) Why does the Judge think that Miss McCutcheon will not last as a teacher? What kind of teacher does he think is needed?

The Judge thinks Miss McCutcheon will not last a month because she is too pretty. He says, 'Too pretty. Our school needs an old battleaxe like the teachers we had when we went to school.' By an old battleaxe he means a strict, experienced teacher who establishes strong discipline — the opposite of a young, pretty newcomer like Miss McCutcheon.

(34) What is Applegarth's complaint about the sea?

Applegarth's complaint about the sea is that the beach is not what it used to be. He does not mind the competition he is getting from the children; his complaint is that the quality of the stuff the sea is washing up is not good any more. As a beach comber, he finds that there is nothing worth picking up and taking home.

(35) What kind of gadget does the writer describe?

The writer describes a gadget in New York, like a safety razor, with which anybody can give anybody else a haircut. There was a full-page advertisement about it in last Sunday's Times, and it costs two dollars and ninety-five cents. A father could save a lot of money giving his children haircuts with it, though the writer admits it is a question of effectiveness, because a boy is ashamed of a bad haircut.

(36) Who buys the oyster? How much does he pay?

The writer buys the oyster. He offers Clay three hundred dollars for it, and hands Clay the money. Clay asks Harry if it is all right, Harry looks at the writer, who nods, and Harry says, 'Sure it's all right.'

(37) Does the writer open the oyster? Why not?

No, the writer does not open the oyster. When Wozzeck asks if he wants to open it first, he says, 'No, I want the whole thing. I don't think the pearl's stopped growing.' He wants to keep the oyster whole, with the dream intact, rather than risk finding nothing inside.

(38) Why does Clark Larrabee return?

Clark Larrabee returns because he saw the classified advertisement in The Gull. He and his truck were ten miles up the highway when he happened to see the ad: 'Clark Larrabee. Come home... We miss you.' So he came back to the house after all, for the weekend, and he says that in two or three months he thinks he will have enough to come back for a long time. He is taking Clay fishing the next morning.

(39) What does the writer do with the oyster?

The writer holds the oyster in front of him as if it were an egg, looks at it carefully, turning it in his fingers, and then puts it in his coat pocket and takes it away unopened. He does not open it at all. As he says, 'As far as I'm concerned, the whole thing's a pearl.'

Exercise II: Questions for discussion (Book p. 54)

(1) Do you think that it is right to allow Clay to believe that there is a pearl in the oyster? Explain briefly.

Yes, I think it is right, as Harry argues. Clay does not really want money; he wants his father to come home, and the belief in the pearl keeps him going while the family waits. Truth can come gently later, when his father

is home and he is no longer troubled. To crush his dream at once, as Miss McCutcheon first wants, would only hurt a child who has already lost his father for a month. On the other hand, Miss McCutcheon's view also has force: truth is supposed to set us free, not imprison us. Harry's answer is a middle way — be a little less sure about things with troubled children, and let the truth come in its own time.

(2) In your opinion, why is the writer willing to buy the pearl? What has he received in return? What does he mean by saying: 'As far as I'm concerned, the whole thing's a pearl.'

The writer is willing to buy the oyster because he sees in it something more valuable than a pearl: a boy's faith, a poor family's hope, and a whole story worth telling. In return he has received the oyster itself, unopened, and the experience of O.K.-by-the-Sea — material for his writing and a glimpse of human goodness. By saying 'the whole thing's a pearl' he means that the oyster, with Clay's dream still alive inside it, is itself precious. Opening it might destroy the dream, but keeping it whole preserves the wonder, and that wonder is the real pearl.

(3) What has attracted Harry and other people to O.K.-by-the-Sea? Is it the kind of town that appeals to you? Do you think that it resembles an ideal town? Give reasons for your answer.

Harry and the other people are attracted to O.K.-by-the-Sea by the sea and the hills, and above all by the chance to take one's time — to live without hurry, worry and competition. Harry stopped there twenty-four years ago because he decided he was not looking for anything anymore, and he found a place where he could take it easy. The town appeals to me for its kindness, its leisure and its closeness to nature, but it also has

real faults: everybody is poor, there are few jobs, and ambitious young people like Miss McCutcheon find nothing to do. It resembles an ideal town only in its human warmth and its freedom from hurry; as a place to live and work, it is far from ideal, because an ideal town must also offer opportunity and a future.

(4) Harry's philosophy is of 'Take it easy' (Relax and enjoy life) nature. How does that philosophy appeal to you? Why or why not? Do you think that this philosophy works better in small towns than in large cities? Explain.

Harry's 'Take it easy' philosophy appeals to me because modern life is full of hurry, worry and competition, and everyone needs rest, laughter and time for family and nature. Relaxing and enjoying life is not laziness; it is what keeps a person healthy and human. But the philosophy cannot be followed blindly: a person must also work, study and meet his responsibilities, or he will fall behind. I think it works better in small towns than in large cities, because in a small town like O.K.-by-the-Sea needs are few, neighbours know one another, and life moves slowly. In a large city, rents, jobs and crowds force people to hurry, and taking it too easy can mean losing one's livelihood.

(5) In your opinion, does the play reveal the author's view of life? If so, what is his view of life?

Yes, the play clearly reveals Saroyan's view of life. As the book's own Theme section says, the play is a sentimental comedy which demonstrates faith in the basic goodness of human nature. Saroyan finds people eminently fascinating and wonderful, although a little 'odd' at times. His view is that life should be enjoyed, relaxed and 'played' as the

play progresses, rather than hurried through; that poor, ordinary people are often the richest in spirit; and that kindness, hope and dreams matter more than money or strict facts. Even the oyster teaches this: the dream inside it is worth more than any pearl that could be found by opening it.

(6) Would you call this play one of 'The action plays'? Why or why not? How would you describe the play to a friend?

No, I would not call this play one of 'the action plays.' There is almost no action in it: nobody fights, nobody chases anybody, and there is no strong plot and no hero. People simply come into a barber's shop, talk, tell stories and go out again. I would describe it to a friend as a gentle, humorous and heart-warming comedy about a small seaside town — a play of characters rather than events, in which a poor boy's dream of a pearl in an oyster brings his father home and teaches a young teacher to be less sure of herself. It is a play to enjoy and relax with, not a thriller.

(7) Do you think that this would be a good play to produce? Why or why not?

Yes, I think this would be a very good play to produce. It needs only one simple set — a barber's shop — and a small cast of ordinary people, so it is cheap and easy to stage. Its humour is gentle, its ending is happy, and its message about human goodness appeals to every audience. The parts are enjoyable to act, especially Harry, Miss McCutcheon and the Judge. The only difficulty is that the play has little action, so the actors must hold the audience by their talking and their characters alone. A good cast could do that easily, and the play would leave the audience smiling.

Exercise III: WHO SAID IT? (Book p. 54)

(a) 'At the same time I have a feeling I ought to stay.' Identify the speaker; to whom, on what occasion, and something about the speaker.

The speaker is Miss McCutcheon (Vivian McCutcheon), the new teacher at the school in O.K.-by-the-Sea. She says it to Harry Van Dusen in his barber shop, when she is asking his advice whether she should quit after one week and go home to San Francisco, or stay. She is a pretty young girl with long blonde hair, who carries a colorful parasol. She is serious about teaching — she is looking for a chance to teach — but the unruly children, who care only for games and the sea, have knocked her for a loop.

(b) 'There's no excuse for this town at all, but the sea is here and so are the hills.' Identify the speaker; to whom, on what occasion, and something about the speaker.

The speaker is Harry Van Dusen, the barber of O.K.-by-the-Sea. He says it to Miss McCutcheon in his shop, when he is describing the town and its people to her. The people are all poor, most cannot afford his haircuts, and there is not one rich man in a town of almost a thousand — yet the sea and the hills are there, and that is enough to keep him. Harry is the only barber in town, a man of about sixty who has been there twenty-four years, who wears a different hat every day and lives by his 'Take-it-easy' philosophy.

(c) '....Clay....well, a fellow like that, you can't just go off and leave him.' Identify the speaker; to whom, on what occasion, and something about

the speaker.

The speaker is Clark Larrabee, Clay's father. He says it to Harry Van Dusen in the barber shop, near the end of the play, after he has come home for the weekend because he saw the advertisement in The Gull. He means that a boy like Clay — brave, hopeful, believing in his pearl — cannot simply be abandoned. Clark is a working man who left his wife Fay after one too many fights about money, worked in Salinas, and now realizes that he must return to his family. He is taking Clay fishing the next morning.

(d) 'It's shut tight, it's alive, and there's a pearl in it, worth at least three hundred dollars.' Identify the speaker; to whom, on what occasion, and something about the speaker.

The speaker is Clay Larrabee, a boy of nine or ten. He says it to Harry Van Dusen in the barber shop, when he brings in the oyster he found near Black Rock. Clay is a poor boy whose father has left home; he needs money to bring his father back and to buy his mother a present. He is hopeful and determined: he went looking for the oyster deliberately, and he firmly believes that a big pearl is inside it.

(e) 'It's never too soon for any of us to face the truth, which is supposed to set us free, not imprison us.' Identify the speaker; to whom, on what occasion, and something about the speaker.

The speaker is Miss McCutcheon, the new school teacher. She says it to the children — Clay, Roxanna and Greeley — in Harry's shop, when she is arguing that the oyster should be opened to show them there is no pearl in it. She believes in facing facts early: truth, she says, is supposed to set us free, not imprison us. She is young, pretty, serious and idealistic, and

she has yet to learn Harry's gentler wisdom about troubled children.

(f) 'Our school needs an old battleaxe, like the teachers we had when we went to school.' Identify the speaker; to whom, on what occasion, and something about the speaker.

The speaker is Judge Applegarth (Arthur Applegarth), the beach comber of O.K.-by-the-Sea. He says it to Harry Van Dusen in the shop, after Miss McCutcheon has gone out, when he declares that she won't last a month because she is too pretty. By an 'old battleaxe' he means a strict, experienced teacher who keeps strong discipline, like the teachers of his own school days. The Judge is not a real judge: he once judged hounds at a county fair, and the town has called him Judge ever since.

Exercise IV: OPTIONAL ACTIVITY (Book p. 54)

(1) Write a composition of 100-150 words explaining why you liked, or did not like, this play.

I liked this play very much, because it is gentle, humorous and full of human kindness. Unlike most plays, it has no villain and no violent action; its charm lies in its characters — Harry with his 'Take-it-easy' philosophy, Clay with his brave belief in the pearl, Miss McCutcheon learning to be less sure of herself, and the Judge with his beach-combing wisdom. The story is simple but moving: a poor boy's dream brings his father home, and a writer pays three hundred dollars not for a pearl but for the dream itself. The play teaches that hope and goodness matter more than facts and money, and it leaves the reader smiling. I also liked the seaside setting and the easy, natural dialogue. If I did not like

anything, it is only that the play has so little action that a restless reader might find it slow. But for anyone who enjoys character and humour, it is a delightful play.

(2) Write a composition describing your ideal town.

My ideal town would be a small, clean town by the sea or in the green hills, like O.K.-by-the-Sea but with more opportunity. It would have good schools with kind, patient teachers, a small hospital, a library and a park where children can play safely. The people would know one another, help one another in trouble, and live without hurry or noise. There would be work for everyone — fishing, farming, small crafts and a few offices — so that no father would have to leave his family to find a job far away. The streets would be safe at night, the air would be fresh, and the town would have a playground, a sports ground and a hall for concerts and dramas. Above all, my ideal town would combine the warmth and leisure of O.K.-by-the-Sea with the chances of a modern town, so that young people could both dream and achieve.

Poem 1: The Rain (W.H. Davies)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 56)

(i) Who was drinking rain?

(a) a man

(b) a bird

✓ (c) the leaves

(d) a tree

(ii) What was making the noise sweet?

(a) a guitar

(b) a singer

(c) drops of rain

✓ (d) drops of rain falling on leaves

(iii) When did the sun come out?

(a) in the morning

(b) in the noon

(c) in the clouds

✓ (d) when the rain would stop

(iv) The round drops are brightened by

✓ (a) sunshine

(b) colour

(c) moonlight

(d) star light

Exercise 2: Mark the statements true or false (Book p. 56)

(i) The poet hears leaves drinking rain. [True]

(ii) The rain drops make the leaves rich. [True]

(iii) The green leaves drinking water create a noise. [True]

(iv) The sunshine darkens the round drops of rain. [False]

(v) The sunshine, after the rain, makes the scene lovely. [True]

Exercise 3: Add two more rhyming words in each line (Book p. 56)

(i) leave, _____, _____

leave, heave, weave (also: grieve, sleeve).

(ii) drop, _____, _____

drop, top, stop.

(iii) rain, _____, _____

rain, again, main (also: plain, train).

Exercise 4: Write a critical appreciation of the poem (Book p. 56)

Write a critical appreciation of the poem 'The Rain'.

W.H. Davies' short poem 'The Rain' is a musical picture of a shower and its aftermath. The poet hears the leaves drinking rain: the rich leaves on top receive the drops first and pass them drop by drop to the poor leaves beneath, making a sweet noise. The poem has a symbolic meaning too: as the book's Theme explains, the rich at the upper level get the golden chance first, and whatever remains trickles down to the people at the

level beneath. When the rain stops and the sun comes out, a wondrous light fills each dark, round drop, and the poet hopes the sun will shine bright and make a lovely sight. The diction is simple and musical, the rhymes (rain/again, top/drop, near/hear) fall gently on the ear, and the whole poem shows Davies' favourite themes — nature and the hardships of the poor — in two short stanzas.

Exercise 5: How can a rainy day be enjoyed? (Book p. 56)

How can a rainy day be enjoyed?

A rainy day can be enjoyed in many ways. One can sit by a window and watch the rain falling on the leaves, listening to its sweet music, as the poet does. Children enjoy splashing in puddles, making paper boats and floating them in running water, and getting wet in a warm shower. At home, a rainy day is a good time for reading a book, drinking hot tea, eating pakoras, and playing indoor games with family. Farmers welcome the rain because it waters their crops. In short, a rainy day becomes enjoyable when we accept it cheerfully instead of complaining about it, and find pleasure in nature's music, in play, and in the company of family.

Exercise 6: Explain the first stanza with reference to context (Book p. 56)

Explain the first stanza of 'The Rain' with reference to context.

Reference: These lines are taken from the poem 'The Rain' by W.H.

Davies. Context: The poet is describing a shower of rain on the leaves of a tree, and the sweet sound it makes. Explanation: The poet says that he hears the leaves drinking rain. The rich leaves on the top of the tree, which are full of water, give drop after drop to the poor leaves beneath them. It is a sweet noise to hear — these green leaves drinking near. The stanza has a symbolic meaning as well: the rich at the upper level receive Nature's gifts first, and only what remains trickles down to the poor below. The poet's simple, musical words make the scene of the rain come alive before our eyes.

Poem 2: Night Mail (W.H. Auden)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book pp. 58-59)

(i) The Night Mail is

(a) an express train

(b) a passenger train

✓ (c) a train that carries mail

(ii) The Night Mail reaches

(a) in time

✓ (b) on time

(c) before time

(iii) On the arrival of Night Mail the birds are

✓ (a) frightened

(b) pleased

(c) flown away

(iv) Why do the sheepdogs continue to sleep on the arrival of the train?

Because they can't

(a) attack her

(b) bite her

✓ (c) change her course

Exercise 2: Mark the statements true or false (Book p. 59)

(i) The Night Mail travels by day. [False]

(ii) It brings flowers and presents for the girls. [False]

(iii) It brings letters for the rich and the poor. [True]

(iv) It snorts noisily like a horse. [True]

(v) It disturbs the life on farms. [False]

(vi) The children peep from bushes at her blank faced coaches. [False]

Exercise 3: Write two more rhyming words in each line (Book p. 59)

(i) mail, _____, _____

mail, rail, trail (also: sail, hail).

(ii) night, _____, _____

night, light, sight (also: bright, flight).

(iii) letter, _____, _____

letter, better, setter.

Poem 3: Loveliest of Trees, the Cherry Now (A.E. Housman)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book pp. 61-62)

(i) Cherry is the loveliest in

(a) winter

✓ (b) spring

(c) summer

(d) autumn

(ii) Easter is a festival of

✓ (a) Christians

(b) Muslims

(c) Hindus

(d) Sikhs

(iii) Cherry is dressed in

(a) pink

(b) red

(c) yellow

✓ (d) white

(iv) Three score years and ten are

(a) forty years

(b) fifty years

(c) sixty years

✓ (d) seventy years

(v) How many years of poet's life would not come again?

(a) ten

✓ (b) twenty

(c) thirty

(d) forty

(vi) Cherry glorifies

(a) life

(b) mind and thought

(c) the city

✓ (d) the environment

Exercise 2: Mark the statements true or false (Book p. 62)

(i) Cherry is a flower and not a fruit. [False]

(ii) Cherry is the loveliest in the Autumn. [False]

(iii) The colour of the flower of cherry is blue. [False]

(iv) Seventy years are sufficient to cherish the beauty of cherry tree. [False]

(v) The cherry blooms in winter. [False]

(vi) Cherry stands about the woodland ride. [True]

(vii) Cherry adds to the glory of Easter. [True]

(viii) "To see the cherry hung with snow" is not worth seeing. [False]

(ix) The cherry turns woodland a haunted land. [False]

(x) The cherry is a feast for eyes. [True]

Exercise 3: Add two more rhyming words in each line (Book p. 62)

1. cherry, _____, _____

cherry, merry, very.

2. hung, _____, _____

hung, young, sung.

3. springs, _____, _____

springs, things, brings.

Exercise 4: Explain the first stanza with reference to context (Book p. 62)

Explain the first stanza of 'Loveliest of Trees, the Cherry Now' with reference to context.

Reference: These lines are taken from the poem 'Loveliest of Trees, the Cherry Now' by A.E. Housman. Context: The poet is describing the cherry tree in full bloom in spring, standing along a path in the woodland. Explanation: The poet says that the cherry, the loveliest of trees, is now hung with bloom along its boughs. It stands beside the woodland ride, wearing white for Eastertide — that is, its white blossoms look like a white dress worn for the Easter festival. The stanza shows the poet's deep love of nature: the cherry in bloom is so beautiful that it seems to dress itself in white for a celebration.

Exercise 5: What time of the year is mentioned in the first stanza? (Book p. 62)

What time of the year is mentioned in the first stanza?

Eastertide is mentioned in the first stanza — that is, the spring season around Easter, when the cherry tree is in full bloom and wears its white blossoms like a white dress.

Exercise 6: Read the second stanza carefully and write how old is the poet? (Book p. 62)

Read the second stanza carefully and write how old is the poet?

The poet is twenty years old. He says that out of his three score years and ten — that is, seventy years, the expected span of life — twenty years will not come again, because they are already past. Taking twenty from seventy leaves him fifty more springs to enjoy. So the poet, at the time of writing, is twenty years of age.

Exercise 7: What is the poet trying to say in the last stanza of the poem? (Book p. 62)

What is the poet trying to say in the last stanza of the poem?

In the last stanza the poet is trying to say that life is too short to enjoy the beauty of nature fully. Since even fifty springs are little room — too short a time — to look at things in bloom, he will not waste any chance: he will go about the woodland to see the cherry hung with snow. The

message is that we should seize every opportunity to enjoy the beauty around us, because life passes quickly and its pleasures will not return.

Poem 4: O Where are You Going? (W.H. Auden)

Exercise 1: Summarize the poem in your own words (Book p. 64)

Summarize the poem 'O Where are You Going?' in your own words.

The poem is a dialogue between two imaginary persons personified as reader and rider. The rider is a bold and courageous person, ambitious to make his way through thick and thin toward the pass of glory. The reader, full of awe and reverence, warns him that the valley beyond is full of dangers: the furnaces burn, the midden's bad smell sickens and maddens the mind, and the gap is the grave where the tall return. Then fearer speaks to farer, and horror speaks to hearer, trying to discourage the traveller with doubts — that dusk will delay him, that his footsteps will fail from granite to grass, that a bird in the twisted trees and a spot on his skin mean disease and death. But the rider is not stopped: he leaves them there, saying 'Out of this house' and 'Yours never will,' and goes on his way. The poem teaches that the way to glory and success is vague and uncertain, but it can be paved through with courage and perseverance.

Exercise 2: Answer the following questions (Book p. 64)

(i) What kinds of feelings does the poet create in the minds of his readers?

The poet creates feelings of awe, fear, suspense and curiosity in the minds of his readers. The warnings of the reader, the fearer and the horror fill the reader with dread about the dangers ahead — burning furnaces, maddening smells, graves, dusk, disease and death. At the same time the rider's boldness creates admiration and hope. The mixture of fear and courage keeps the reader in suspense until the end, when the rider leaves his discouragers behind.

(i) How do you feel after reading the poem?

After reading the poem I feel both afraid and encouraged. The warnings about the valley, the grave and the disease are frightening, and they make me realize how many dangers lie on the road to success. But the rider's courage encourages me: he does not listen to fear, and he goes on his way. I feel that fear is only a voice trying to stop us, and that a brave person must leave it behind and keep moving toward his goal.

(ii) What does the title of the poem signify?

The title 'O Where are You Going?' signifies the question that fear and doubt put to every ambitious person. The reader asks the rider where he is going, because his journey seems dangerous and foolish. The question stands for all the warnings of the world: where are you going, and do you know the dangers ahead? The poem answers that a courageous person knows his goal and goes on, even when others question his journey.

(iii) Write down the rhyming words in the poem.

The rhyming words in the poem are: burn — return (first stanza); pass — grass (second stanza); trees — disease (third stanza); and reader — farer — horror — there (last stanza). The opening words of the first three stanzas — rider, farer, hearer — also echo one another in sound.

(iv) Explain the third stanza of the poem in your own words.

In the third stanza horror speaks to hearer. Horror asks, 'O what was that bird?' and asks whether the hearer saw a shape in the twisted trees. Horror warns that behind him, swiftly and softly, a figure is coming, and that the spot on his skin is a shocking disease. In other words, horror tries to frighten the traveller with mysterious shapes, unseen followers and signs of illness, so that he will give up his journey. The stanza shows how fear invents dangers — a bird, a shape, a spot — to discourage a brave person.

Exercise 3: Mark the statements true / false (Book p. 64)

(a) The valley is fatal when the furnaces burn. [True]

(b) That dusk will not delay on your path to the pass. [False]

(c) Your footsteps feel from granite to grass. [True]

(d) The spot on your skin is a shocking disease. [True]

Poem 5: In the Street of the Fruit Stalls (Jan Stallworthy)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 66)

(i) Which fruit has not been mentioned in the poem?

✓ (a) mango

(b) melon

(c) guava

(d) mandarin

(ii) The fruit resembled the _____.

(a) vegetables

✓ (b) cannon balls

(c) bullets

(d) biscuits

(iii) It was a _____ street.

✓ (a) dark

(b) bright

(c) airy

(d) blind

(iv) The children were _____.

(a) pale

✓ (b) dark

(c) white

(d) yellow

Exercise 2: Mark the statements true / false (Book p. 66)

(i) No fruit has been mentioned in the poem. [False]

(ii) The children did not want to buy the fruit. [False]

(iii) The children were holding coins in their hands. [True]

(iv) They ate the fruit with relish. [True]

Exercise 3: Add two more rhyming words to each of the words given below (Book p. 66)

(i) falls, _____, _____

falls, walls, calls.

(ii) spend, _____, _____

spend, end, friend.

(iii) skin, _____, _____

skin, in, chin (also: win).

(iv) forget, _____, _____

forget, yet, set (also: met, wet).

Exercise 4: Write down the missing word in each verse (Book p. 67)

(i) Wicks balance flame, a dark dew _____.

✓ (a) falls

(b) calls

(c) moves

(d) comes

(ii) Pyramid-piled like cannon _____.

(a) bullets

✓ (b) balls

(c) guns

(d) spears

(iii) The sun in a pitted _____.

✓ (a) skin

(b) rim

(c) arm

(d) leg

(iv) The dark street I am standing _____.

(a) out

✓ (b) in

(c) into

(d) on

Exercise 5: Write a critical note on the poem (Book p. 67)

Write a critical note on the poem 'In the Street of the Fruit Stalls'.

Jan Stallworthy's poem is a symbolic picture of life in a poor street at evening. In the dark street, lit only by lanterns, fruit sellers pile melon, guava and mandarin in pyramids that glow red-hot and gold-hot from within, like cannon balls. Dark children with a coin to spend enter the lantern's orbit, buy fruit, break it open, and let its gold or silver fountain wet their mouths, fingers, cheeks, noses and chins. Radiant as lanterns, they forget the dark street the poet is standing in. The poem's power lies in its contrast: the world is threatened with war, misery and poverty, yet these have failed to crush man's love for pleasure. The children's joy, innocent and complete, shines against the darkness. The imagery is vivid and sensuous — colour, light, taste and touch all combine — and the short, musical lines make the scene glow like the lanterns themselves.

Exercise 6: Give a summary of the poem in your own words (Book p. 67)

Give a summary of the poem 'In the Street of the Fruit Stalls' in your own words.

It is evening in a dark street of fruit stalls. The lantern wicks balance their flames, and a dark dew falls. Melon, guava and mandarin are piled in pyramids like cannon balls, glowing red-hot and gold-hot from within in the lantern light. Dark children, each with a coin to spend, come into the circle of lantern light and look at the fruit: the moon is compacted to a rind, the sun is in a pitted skin. They buy a fruit, break it open, and let its

gold or silver juice wet their mouths, fingers, cheeks, noses and chins. Radiant as lanterns themselves, they forget the dark street in which the poet stands watching them. The poem thus shows how a small pleasure can make poor children forget their misery for a while.

Exercise 7: What are the feelings of the poet standing in the dark? (Book p. 67)

What are the feelings of the poet standing in the dark?

The poet, standing in the dark street, feels both pity and wonder. He pities the poor children and the misery of the world around them — the darkness, the war and the poverty that threaten life. At the same time he feels wonder and delight at the children's innocent joy: radiant as lanterns, they forget their misery in the sweet spray of the juice. His feelings are therefore mixed — sadness for the dark world, and admiration for the human love of pleasure that even poverty cannot crush.

Exercise 8: Why has the poet used 'cannon balls' to describe the fruit? (Book p. 67)

Why has the poet used 'cannon balls' to describe the fruit?

The poet has used 'cannon balls' to describe the fruit for two reasons. First, the shape: the melons, guavas and mandarins are piled in pyramids, round and heavy like cannon balls stacked for a gun. Second, the contrast: cannon balls are instruments of war and destruction, while

fruit is a symbol of life and pleasure. By calling the fruit cannon balls, the poet reminds us that this is a world threatened by war — yet the fruit, glowing red-hot and gold-hot, turns the weapons of war into objects of joy. The image thus joins the poem's two themes: war and pleasure.

Exercise 9: Paraphrase the last stanza in your own words (Book p. 67)

Paraphrase the last stanza of the poem in your own words.

The children take the fruit, break it open, and let its golden or silver juice flow over their mouths, fingers, cheeks, noses and chins. Shining as brightly as the lanterns themselves, they completely forget the dark street in which the poet is standing. In other words, the children's delight in the fruit is so complete that it makes them forget their poor and dark surroundings for a time.

Exercise 10: Make a list of fruits described in the poem (Book p. 67)

Make a list of fruits described in the poem.

The fruits described in the poem are: melon, guava and mandarin. The melon is like the moon compacted to a rind, and the mandarin (small orange) is like the sun in a pitted skin. All three are piled in pyramids like cannon balls and glow red-hot and gold-hot from within in the lantern light.

Poem 6: A Sindhi Woman (Jan Stallworthy)

Exercise 1: Add two more rhyming words in the blanks with each word (Book p. 69)

(a) grace, _____, _____

grace, face, place.

(b) tread, _____, _____

tread, head, bread.

(c) crumbs, _____, _____

crumbs, slums, plums.

(d) weight, _____, _____

weight, straight, great.

Exercise 2: Write down the missing rhyming words in each verse (Book p. 69)

(a) High on her _____.

(i) red

✓ (ii) head

(iii) body

(iv) foot

(b) As the cloth blown back from her _____.

(i) mouth

(ii) head

✓ (iii) face

(iv) hair

(c) Watching her cross _____.

(i) bridge

(ii) street

(iii) road

✓ (iv) erect

(d) I, with my stoop, _____.

(i) walk

(ii) run

(iii) think

✓ (iv) reflect

Exercise 3: Give a summary of the poem in your own words (Book p. 69)

Give a summary of the poem 'A Sindhi Woman' in your own words.

A Sindhi woman walks barefoot through a bazaar, carrying a stone jar high on her head. She moves with the same undulant grace as the cloth blown back from her face, gliding smoothly with not a ripple in her tread. The poet watches her cross erect over the stones, garbage, excrement and crumbs of glass in the Karachi slums. He himself, with his stoop —

bent by an idle, unburdened life — reflects that they stand most straight who learn to walk beneath a weight. The poem is thus a tribute to a working woman, who has practically turned her work into an art, walking softly with the delicacy and rhythm of a dancer's feet.

Exercise 4: What did the poet reflect when he saw the woman? (Book p. 69)

What did the poet reflect when he saw the woman?

When the poet saw the woman, he reflected that they stand most straight who learn to walk beneath a weight. The woman, carrying a stone jar on her head through the slums, walks erect and graceful, while he himself, with his stoop, is bent. He realized that only those who bear the burden of life and carry its hardships through life are strong and straight, while an idle person, who carries no weight, soon decays and stoops.

Exercise 5: What is the main idea of the poem? (Book p. 69)

What is the main idea of the poem 'A Sindhi Woman'?

The main idea of the poem is that work creates rhythm in life and keeps a person strong and vigilant, while idleness makes a person decay. It is a tribute to a working woman: the Sindhi woman, carrying a stone jar through the Karachi slums, has practically turned her work into an art. The poem also shows that those who bear the burdens of life stand most straight, and that dignity and grace are found in honest labour, not in

ease.

Exercise 6: What picture of the Karachi slums do we get after reading the poem? (Book p. 69)

What picture of the Karachi slums do we get after reading the poem?

After reading the poem we get a realistic and grim picture of the Karachi slums. The ground is covered with stones, garbage, excrement and crumbs of glass. The slums are heavily populated areas of the city with much poverty and poor facilities. Through this dirty, neglected scene the Sindhi woman walks barefoot, erect and graceful, which makes the contrast between the ugliness of the slums and the dignity of the working woman all the sharper.

Exercise 7: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 69)

(a) The woman in the poem was passing through the _____.

(i) market

✓ (ii) bazaar

(iii) crowd

(iv) street

(b) She was carrying a _____ on her head.

(i) a bundle of sticks

✓ (ii) a stone jar

(iii) a bundle of books

(iv) nothing

(c) Those who carry weight stand _____.

✓ (i) straight

(ii) bend

(iii) idle

(iv) fall

(d) Her walk was _____.

✓ (i) smooth

(ii) difficult

(iii) slow

(iv) fast

Exercise 8: Mark the statements true / false (Book p. 69)

(a) She was bare footed. [True]

(b) She had a stone jar on her head. [True]

(c) She was a Baluchi woman. [False]

(d) She did not have a ripple in her walk. [True]

Poem 7: Times (From Ecclesiastes, 3:1-12)

Exercise 1: Explain the message in the first eight lines of the poem in your own words (Book p. 71)

Explain the message in the first eight lines of the poem 'Times' in your own words.

The first eight lines of the poem give the message that to everything there is a season, and a time to every purpose under heaven. There is a time to be born and a time to die; a time to plant and a time to pluck up that which is planted; a time to break down and a time to build up; a time to weep and a time to dance. In other words, nothing in this world happens out of place: birth and death, sowing and harvesting, destruction and construction all come at their own appointed times, and man must accept this divine schedule with patience.

Exercise 2: Read the poem and complete the lines (Book p. 71)

(a) A time to be born / And a time to _____.

die.

(b) A time to break down / And a time to _____.

build up.

(c) A time to laugh / And a time to _____.

weep. (In the full passage of Ecclesiastes: 'A time to weep, and a time to

laugh.')

(d) A time to get / And a time to _____.

lose.

(e) A time to keep silence / And a time to _____.

speak.

Exercise 3: Silence is an antonym of speech. Write down the antonyms of these words (Book p. 71)

(i) born _____

die.

(ii) heaven _____

hell.

(iii) live _____

die.

(iv) lose _____

get (find).

(v) weep _____

laugh.

(vi) break _____

build (make, mend).

Exercise 4: Write in your own words the critical appreciation of the poem (Book p. 71)

Write in your own words the critical appreciation of the poem 'Times'.

The poem 'Times', taken from Ecclesiastes (3:1-12), is a solemn meditation on the order of life. Its theme is that everything happens at an appropriate time: there is a time when winter sets in and a time when winter is gone and another season sets in; nobody is born before time, nor dies before time; there is a time to sow seeds and a time when their fruits are ripe to be plucked. Nothing in this world happens out of place; everything is scheduled according to a specific time. The poem's power lies in its parallel structure — 'a time to...' repeated again and again — which gives it the rhythm of a sermon and the dignity of scripture. Its language is simple, yet its message is profound: man should accept the seasons of his life, in joy and in sorrow, with patience and faith.

Poem 8: Ozymandias (Percy Bysshe Shelley)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 73)

(i) The traveller saw a _____ in the desert.

(a) snake

✓ (b) statue

(c) camel

(d) water

(ii) The poet met a _____.

✓ (a) traveller

(b) sailor

(c) beggar

(d) captain

(iii) His name was written on the _____.

(a) face

(b) body

✓ (c) pedestal

(d) wood

(iv) The wreck of the statue was _____.

✓ (a) colossal

(b) small

(c) big

(d) little

Exercise 2: Mark the statements true / false (Book p. 73)

(i) The traveller belonged to an ancient country. [True]

(ii) The traveller saw nothing in the desert. [False]

(iii) Nothing was written on the pedestal of the statue. [False]

(iv) Ozymandias was a prince. [False]

Exercise 3: Add two more rhyming words to each word given below (Book p. 74)

(i) land, _____, _____

land, sand, hand.

(ii) stone, _____, _____

stone, lone, throne (also: bone).

(iii) decay, _____, _____

decay, away, day.

(iv) fed, _____, _____

fed, head, dead.

Exercise 4: Write down the missing word in each verse (Book p. 74)

(i) I met a traveller from an antique _____.

(a) sand

(b) band

✓ (c) land

(d) hand

(ii) Two vast and trunkless legs of stone stood in the _____.

(a) jungle

✓ (b) desert

(c) hill

(d) ground

(iii) My name is Ozymandias, king of _____.

(a) state

(b) America

✓ (c) kings

(d) Rome

(iv) Of that colossal wreck, boundless and _____.

✓ (a) bare

(b) rare

(c) uncovered

(d) head less

Exercise 5: Give a summary of the poem (Book p. 74)

Give a summary of the poem 'Ozymandias'.

The poet met a traveller from an ancient land who told him that in the desert stand two vast, trunkless legs of stone. Near them, half sunk in the sand, lies a shattered face — a visage with a frown, a wrinkled lip and a sneer of cold command. The sculptor understood the king's passions

well, and stamped them on the lifeless stone; the hand that mocked them and the heart that fed them are both gone. On the pedestal of the statue are inscribed the proud words: 'My name is Ozymandias, king of kings: Look on my works, ye Mighty, and despair!' But nothing beside remains. Round the decay of that colossal wreck, boundless and bare, the lone and level sands stretch far away. The poem is thus an ironic picture of human pride destroyed by time.

Exercise 6: What kinds of feelings does the poem create in the reader's mind? (Book p. 74)

What kinds of feelings does the poem create in the reader's mind?

The poem creates feelings of irony, pity and awe in the reader's mind. Irony, because the proud boast on the pedestal — 'Look on my works, ye Mighty, and despair!' — is mocked by the empty desert around it, where nothing remains. Pity, because the great king who thought he had toppled the world is now only a broken statue in the sand. Awe, because the poem makes us feel the power of time, which brings all the luxuries of life to an end and levels kings and common men alike. It also creates humility: the reader feels that all feelings of superiority in man are only an illusion and self-deception.

Exercise 7: What did the traveller see in the desert? (Book p. 74)

What did the traveller see in the desert?

In the desert the traveller saw two vast and trunkless legs of stone standing in the sand. Near them, on the sand, half sunk, lay a shattered visage — the broken face of the statue — with a frown, a wrinkled lip and a sneer of cold command. On the pedestal of the statue he read the words: 'My name is Ozymandias, king of kings: Look on my works, ye Mighty, and despair!' Around the colossal wreck there was nothing else — only the lone and level sands stretching far away.

Poem 9: The Feed (Ahmed Nadeem Qasmi)

Exercise 1: Answer the following questions (Book p. 76)

(i) What does the sparrow hold in her beak?

The sparrow holds a grain of millet in her beak.

(ii) Which line in the first stanza tells us that the young ones have no feathers?

The line 'From head to toe they are beaks / When they cry' tells us that the young ones have no feathers yet. They are so tiny and newly born that, when they cry, they seem to be nothing but open beaks from head to toe.

(iii) How many young ones are to be fed?

Ten young ones are to be fed: 'One grain to be fed to the ten young ones.'

(iv) What has the poet described in the poem?

The poet has described the love of a mother bird for her young ones. The mother sparrow goes out and brings a single grain of millet in her beak to feed her ten tiny young ones, who are only a few days old and are waiting in the nest with open beaks.

Exercise 2: Choose the correct answer (Book p. 76)

(i) What was the mother sparrow holding in her beak?

(a) wheat

(b) rice

✓ (c) millet

(d) maize

(ii) The young ones are tiny and _____.

(a) big

✓ (b) small

(c) white

(d) black

(iii) How many young ones are there in the nest?

(a) three

✓ (b) ten

(c) twelve

(d) nine

(iv) Name the bird that has come to feed her young ones.

(a) crow

(b) pigeon

✓ (c) sparrow

(d) parrot

Exercise 3: Read the poem and write down the missing word in each line (Book p. 76)

(i) From head to toe they are _____.

beaks.

(ii) The mother sparrow has come to _____.

feed.

(iii) One grain to be fed to the _____ young ones.

ten.

Exercise 4: Mark the statements true or false (Book p. 76)

(i) The young ones are tiny and small. [True]

(ii) The mother sparrow holds a grain of rice in her beak. [False]

(iii) The young ones do not weep and wail in a loud tone. [False]

(iv) One grain is to be fed to the six young ones. [False]

Exercise 5: Explain the last three lines of this poem with reference to the context (Book p. 76)

Explain the last three lines of 'The Feed' with reference to the context.

Reference: These lines are taken from the poem 'The Feed' by Ahmed Nadeem Qasmi. Context: The mother sparrow has brought only one grain of millet for her ten tiny young ones, and the poet turns to the reader with a question. Explanation: The poet says that man has learnt to set life on foot — that is, human beings have learnt great skills, like splitting the atom and starting new life. Then he asks, 'Could you split the grain?' — could man, with all his science, divide one tiny grain of millet fairly among ten hungry young ones? The last line repeats the problem: 'One grain to be fed to the ten young ones.' The poet means that the mother's love faces an impossible task, and that human science, for all its power, cannot solve the simple, heart-breaking problem of sharing one grain among ten.

Exercise 6: Write a critical appreciation of the poem (Book p. 76)

Write a critical appreciation of the poem 'The Feed'.

Ahmed Nadeem Qasmi's poem 'The Feed' is a very simple poem with a deep meaning. It describes a mother sparrow who brings a single grain of millet in her beak to feed her ten young ones, who are so tiny and small that from head to toe they are beaks when they cry. The poet then turns the picture into a question for mankind: man has learnt to split the atom

and to set life on foot, but could he split one grain among ten hungry mouths? The poem's beauty lies in this contrast between the smallness of the scene and the greatness of its message — a mother's love, the problem of poverty and sharing, and the limits of human science. The language is plain and touching, the image of the ten open beaks is unforgettable, and the closing question stays in the reader's mind long after the poem ends.

Exercise 7: What do you feel after reading the poem? (Book p. 76)

What do you feel after reading the poem 'The Feed'?

After reading the poem I feel pity and admiration. I feel pity for the ten tiny young ones, who are hungry and have only one grain of millet to share among them, and for their mother, who cannot feed them all. I feel admiration for the mother sparrow's love and devotion, which makes her bring whatever she can find to her nest. I also feel thoughtful: the poet's question — could man, who can split the atom, split one grain among ten? — makes me realize that science cannot solve every human problem, and that love and sharing matter more than power.

Poem 10: The Hollow Men (T.S. Eliot)

Exercise 1: Choose the correct answer from the options given below (Book p. 78)

(i) The poet calls men _____.

(a) hungry

(b) thirsty

✓ (c) hollow

(d) cruel

(ii) This poem has been written by _____.

(a) Keats

✓ (b) T. S. Eliot

(c) W. B. Yeats

(d) Byron

(iii) The title of the poem is _____.

✓ (a) The hollow men

(b) The hollow man

(c) The hollow woman

(d) The hollow women

(iv) We convey _____.

✓ (a) nothing

(b) something

(c) anything

(d) a few words

Exercise 2: Mark the statements true / false (Book p. 78)

(i) We are hollow men. [True]

(ii) We do not whisper together. [False]

(iii) Shape without form, shade with colour. [False]

(iv) We do not learn together. [False]

Exercise 3: Add two more rhyming words to each of the words given below (Book p. 79)

(i) hollow, _____, _____

hollow, follow, swallow.

(ii) glass, _____, _____

glass, grass, class.

(iii) colour, _____, _____

colour, collar, dollar (slant rhymes).

(iv) wind, _____, _____

wind, kind, mind (also: find, blind).

Exercise 4: Write down the missing words in each verse (Book p. 79)

(i) We are hollow _____.

✓ (a) men

(b) boys

(c) women

(d) girls

(ii) Or rats' feet over broken _____.

(a) table

(b) chair

✓ (c) glass

(d) mirror

(iii) Remember us, if at all, not as _____.

✓ (a) lost

(b) found

(c) unwise

(d) hungry

(iv) Violent souls, but _____.

✓ (a) only

(b) really

(c) dead

(d) alive

Exercise 5: Write a critical note on the poem (Book p. 79)

Write a critical note on the poem 'The Hollow Men'.

T.S. Eliot's 'The Hollow Men' is a powerful modern poem about the emptiness of modern life. The poet calls modern men 'hollow men' and 'stuffed men': they lean together, their heads are filled with straw, and their dried voices, when they whisper together, are quiet and meaningless as wind in dry grass or rats' feet over broken glass in a dry cellar. They have shape without form, shade without colour, paralysed force and gesture without motion. The poem's imagery is strange and haunting — straw-filled heads, dry cellars, broken glass — and its short, broken lines sound like the meaningless whispering they describe. Its message is that human beings have become soulless: they depend on each other but cannot make a society, and they only seem to be walking souls, while actually they are not even that.

Exercise 6: Give a summary of the poem (Book p. 79)

Give a summary of the poem 'The Hollow Men'.

The poet says: We are the hollow men, we are the stuffed men, leaning together, with our headpieces filled with straw. Our dried voices, when we whisper together, are quiet and meaningless, like wind in dry grass or rats' feet over broken glass in our dry cellar. We have shape without form, shade without colour, paralysed force and gesture without motion. Those who have crossed with direct eyes to death's other Kingdom should remember us — if at all — not as lost, violent souls, but only as

the hollow men, the stuffed men. In short, modern men are empty inside: they look like men, but they have no soul, no force and no meaning.

Exercise 7: Why does the poet call modern men as hollow men? (Book p. 79)

Why does the poet call modern men as hollow men?

The poet calls modern men hollow men because they have become soulless and empty inside. They have bodies and shapes, but inside there is nothing: their heads are filled with straw, their voices are dry and meaningless, and their gestures have no motion. They depend on each other and lean together, but they cannot make a real society, and all their efforts are like the running of rats or the rustling of grass. They only seem to be walking souls, but actually they are not even that. Like stuffed dolls, they have an outer form without any inner life.

Exercise 8: What does the poet say in the last stanza of the poem? (Book p. 79)

What does the poet say in the last stanza of the poem?

In the last stanza of the excerpt the poet addresses those who have crossed with direct eyes to death's other Kingdom — that is, those who have died with courage and clear vision. He asks them to remember the hollow men, if they remember them at all, not as lost, violent souls, but only as the hollow men, the stuffed men. In other words, the hollow men do not even deserve to be called wicked or lost, because they never had

the force to be either good or evil; they were only empty.

Poem 11: Leisure (William Henry Davies)

Exercise 1: Read the poem and complete the lines with rhyming words (Book p. 81)

(i) What is this life if, full of care / We have no time to stand and _____.

stare.

(ii) No time to see in broad day _____ / Streams full of stars, like skies at night.

light.

(iii) A poor life this if, full of care / We have no time to stand and _____.

stare.

Exercise 2: Why do you think the poet has given this title to his poem when he is talking about life full of care with no time to stand and stare? (100 to 150 words) (Book p. 81)

Why has the poet given the title 'Leisure' to his poem when he is talking about life full of care with no time to stand and stare?

The poet has given his poem the title 'Leisure' because the whole poem is about the absence of leisure in modern life. The title is deliberately

ironic: it names the very thing that modern man has lost. We are so busy coping with the daily routine of life, so full of care and worry, that we have no time to stand beneath the boughs and stare as long as sheep or cows, no time to see streams full of stars in broad daylight, no time to turn at Beauty's glance and watch her feet dance, and no time to wait till her smile enriches our eyes. Leisure — free time to enjoy the beauty and joys of life — is exactly what we lack, and without it, as the last lines say, life is a poor life indeed. The title therefore protests against a life without leisure and reminds us of what we have lost.

Exercise 3: What is the poet trying to say in the last two lines of the poem? (Book p. 81)

What is the poet trying to say in the last two lines of the poem?

In the last two lines — 'A poor life this if, full of care, / We have no time to stand and stare' — the poet is trying to say that a life which is full of worries and has no leisure is a poor life indeed. If man cannot spare even a moment to stand and look at the beauty around him, his life is not worth living. The lines sum up the whole poem: without time to enjoy nature and beauty, life loses its richness and becomes merely a burden of care.

Exercise 4: Write down the pairs of all rhyming words in the poem (Book p. 81)

Write down the pairs of all rhyming words in the poem 'Leisure'.

The pairs of rhyming words in the poem are: care — stare; boughs — cows; daylight — night; glance — dance; can — began; and again care — stare (in the closing couplet).

Poem 12: Ruba'iyat (Allama Muhammad Iqbal)

Exercise: Answer the following questions (Book p. 83)

1. Who was Abraham?

Abraham (Hazrat Ibrahim, peace be upon him) was a great prophet of God. Though he was thrown into the fire by his opponents, he was saved by his faith in God. In the poem he is the symbol of strong faith: to be self-honoring and God-drunk, like Abraham at the stake, is faith.

2. What is worse than slavery?

To have no faith is worse than slavery. The poet says plainly, 'To have no faith is worse than slavery.' A man without faith has lost his dignity and freedom of soul, and is worse off than a slave.

3. Who cannot compete with the civilization of Makkah?

The civilization of Europe cannot compete with the civilization of Makkah. The poet says that the soul of Europe is empty of concord, and its civilization bends to no Makkah — that is, it has no resemblance to the spiritual civilization of Makkah and no true harmony.

4. What has made the efforts of Muslims fruitless?

The disappearance of love's madness has made the efforts of Muslims fruitless. The spark that once ignited love has gone; the blood running in the veins of the Muslims has thinned and lost its warmth. As a result, Islamic unity has broken, hearts are perplexed, prayers have become cold, and feelings have become superficial and devoid of love. Without faith and love, their efforts bear no fruit.

5. What is the moral lesson of the poem?

The moral lesson of the poem is that strong faith, like the faith of Hazrat Abraham, is the greatest need of this modern age of allurement. A man without faith is worse than a slave. Muslim harmony depends upon true faith in Islam, blended with strong Islamic values and local feelings. The material civilization of Europe, empty of spiritual concord, cannot compete with the civilization of Makkah. Muslims must therefore revive the love and faith that once made them one nation.

6. What is the present state of the Muslims as given in the last stanza of the poem?

According to the last stanza, the present state of the Muslims is sad: love's madness has departed from them, and the blood in their veins runs thin. Their ranks are broken, their hearts are perplexed, their prayers are cold, and no feeling is deeper than the skin. Their unity is broken and their religion has become superficial, without warmth or depth.

7. Explain the last two lines in the second stanza of the poem.

The last two lines of the second stanza are: 'Empty of concord is the soul of Europe, / Whose civilization to no Makkah bends.' They mean that the

soul of Europe is empty of harmony and agreement: European civilization has no spiritual concord and no unity of purpose. Moreover, it does not bow to Makkah — it has no resemblance to the civilization of Makkah, which is founded on faith in one God and on spiritual values. The poet contrasts the empty, discordant soul of Europe with the harmonious, faith-based civilization of Islam.

Poem 13: A Tale of Two Cities (John Peter)

Exercise 1: Why did the people of the two cities look powerless and helpless? (Book p. 85)

Why did the people of the two cities look powerless and helpless?

The people of the two cities looked powerless and helpless because of the storms of the shrills of arms, smoke and drills. The atomic bombs exploded on their cities, and all the people were scarred, burnt and afraid. Against such destruction no human power could stand, so they were made powerless and helpless.

Exercise 2: Describe the circumstances the victims had to pass through (Book p. 85)

Describe the circumstances the victims had to pass through.

The victims had to pass through the most cruel circumstances. Woeful were all the hills and wasteful were all the grills; there was none to share

their moans and none to lessen their groans. The flowers and flavours were all smashed, burnt, crushed and dashed, and all passed through the grind, leaving nothing behind. They suffered all the pains and pangs of the atomic explosion, yet they bore them patiently and boldly and did not lose heart.

Exercise 3: Describe the scene of devastation (Book p. 85)

Describe the scene of devastation.

The scene of devastation was terrible beyond description. No eye could look at the explosion that took the lives of two glories — the two cities of Japan — in the moments of furies. In the storms of arms, smoke and drills, all were scarred, burnt and afraid. The flowers and flavours were smashed, burnt, crushed and dashed, and all passed through the grind, leaving nothing behind. The glory of the culture and civilization of the two cities was destroyed in a moment.

Exercise 4: What is the moral lesson of the poem? (Book p. 85)

What is the moral lesson of the poem?

The moral lesson of the poem is given in its last lines: 'Ashes are not merely the waste / They can really create the great.' Even after total destruction, a nation can rise again through great will and determination. The people of the two cities suffered patiently and boldly, did not lose heart, and rose from the ashes to the heights as an economic power. Suffering, borne with courage, can become the foundation of greatness.

Exercise 5: Write down the rhyming words and use them in your sentences (Book p. 85)

Write down the rhyming words of the poem and use them in your sentences.

The rhyming words of the poem, used in sentences, are: (1) shrills — drills: The shrills of the sirens mixed with the drills of the soldiers. (2) afraid — made: The people were afraid, and the blast made them helpless. (3) hills — grills: Woeful were all the hills, and wasteful were all the grills. (4) moans — groans: None shared their moans, and none lessened their groans. (5) smashed — dashed: The flowers were smashed and dashed to the ground. (6) grind — behind: All passed through the grind, leaving nothing behind. (7) look — took: No eye could look at the explosion that took so many lives. (8) glories — furies: The explosion took the lives of two glories in the moments of furies. (9) nation — passion: All was done by a nation in her wild passion. (10) rights — fights: She cared not for human rights, nor saved them from deadly fights. (11) they — day: How great were they who bore the pains of black day. (12) waste — great: Ashes are not merely the waste; they can really create the great.

Exercise 6: Write two more rhyming words (Book p. 85)

(i) afraid, _____, _____

afraid, made, shade (also: grade).

(ii) moans, _____, _____

moans, groans, stones.

(iii) kites, _____, _____

kites, rights, flights (also: nights, lights).

Poem 14: My Neighbour Friend Breathing His Last! (Bullah Shah; translated by A.R. Luther)

Exercise: Answer the following questions (Book p. 87)

1. When does a person remember God?

A person remembers God when he is faced with death and feels helpless. In the poem, when the poet sees his neighbour friend breathing his last, he cries out in shock, 'What should I do, O God! Aghast!' It is in the moment of death, when human power fails, that man turns to God.

2. What is the effect of the death scene?

The effect of the death scene is terror and shock. The poet is aghast: on every side there is talk of departing, and at every place there are shrieks in stock. Flames flare up in his heart to their height, and no charming sight remains visible to him. Everything charming in the world becomes invisible before the reality of death.

3. Why does a person feel helpless on the death of a friend?

A person feels helpless on the death of a friend because death cannot be

stopped or delayed. The friend has to leave and cannot remain; his companions are already ready to catch the train — that is, the journey of death. Man can neither keep his friend back nor follow him, and so he stands aghast, crying, 'What should I do, O God!'

4. Without whose love is Bullah at a loss?

Without the love of God, Bullah is at a loss. The poet says, 'Without His love, Bullah in loss, / Can hardly dwell here or across.' That is, without God's love, man can hardly live in this world or in the next.

5. Write down the rhyming words used in the poem.

The rhyming words used in the poem are: last — Aghast; remain — train; talk — stock; height — sight; loss — across. The refrain 'What should I do, O God! Aghast!' closes every stanza.

6. The poet arrives at a certain conclusion in the last three lines of the poem. What is it? Write in your own words.

In the last three lines the poet arrives at the conclusion that the love of God is the only thing that matters. He says that without His love, Bullah is in loss and can hardly dwell here or across — that is, neither in this world nor in the next. All the charms of the world become invisible before death, and the only appreciable thing left is the love of God, without which everyone is at a loss.

7. Paraphrase the poem in your own words.

The poet says: My neighbour friend is breathing his last. What should I do, O God! I am terrified! He has to leave now and cannot remain; his companions are ready to catch the train of death. On every side there is

talk of departing, and at every place there are shrieks and cries. Flames of grief flare up in my heart to their full height, and no charming sight is visible any more. Without the love of God, Bullah is in loss and can hardly live in this world or the next. What should I do, O God! I am terrified! The poem thus shows that death makes man helpless, and that only the love of God gives him support.

Poem 15: He Came to Know Himself (Sachal Sarmast)

Exercise: Answer the following questions (Book p. 89)

1. Why does the poet put emphasis on how to know himself?

The poet puts emphasis on knowing oneself because one who knows himself also knows that he is a wonderful thing created by the Creator. Such a person cannot have a view of anything else except God Almighty. Self-knowledge is thus the door to God-knowledge: when man knows what he really is, he starts loving God, Who blesses him with great love, and every other thing becomes useless to him.

2. What makes one entangled in love?

The realization of God makes one entangled in love. When a person comes to know himself and realizes that he is created by God and that God is his Beloved, he gets enmeshed in love. The knowledge that God loves him, and that he exists only to know and love God, entangles him completely in divine love.

3. Why did Mansur mount the gallows?

Mansur mounted the gallows just to have his head cut off for the love of his Beloved, God. In the madness of divine love, he felt pleased and willing to be hanged on the gallows. Like Mansur, a person who is truly in love with God does not fear death; he gladly gives his head for his Beloved.

4. What is the bare Truth?

The bare Truth, which Sachu speaks plainly, is that God Himself came down to earth in love, and that man's stay in this world is only temporary. He who knows himself knows God, and knows that everything else is useless beside the love of the Beloved. The Truth is that union of one soul with another soul through the alchemy of love is the highest mystic truth.

5. Explain these lines: 'He alighted from high heaven / To pour a cascade of love'.

These lines mean that God came down from high heaven to earth out of love for mankind. Just as a cascade or waterfall pours down in abundance, God poured His love upon the world in full measure. The Divine descended from heaven so that man might know Him and love Him, and so that the dry hearts of men might be filled with the waters of divine love.

6. What does the poet say about 'His sojourn on earth' in the last line?

About 'His sojourn on earth' the poet says that it was temporary. A sojourn means a temporary stay in a place. God's stay on earth, like man's stay in this world, was not permanent: He came down in love, poured His cascade of love, and departed. The poet thus reminds us that

this world is only a temporary abode, and that man should use his short stay here to know himself and to love God.

Poem 16: God's Attributes (Jalaluddin Rumi; translated by Dr. Nicholson)

Exercises (Book p. 90)

1. How many attributes are mentioned in the poem?

Three attributes of God are mentioned in the poem: Seeing, Hearing and Knowing. God calls Himself 'Seeing', 'Hearing' and 'Knowing', each to a purpose for man's guidance.

2. What makes one scared of sinning?

The knowledge that God is All-Seeing makes one scared of sinning. God calls Himself 'Seeing' to the end that His eye may scare you from sinning: when a person remembers that God sees every deed, he becomes afraid to commit a sin.

3. What are the effects of the attributes of God?

The effects of the attributes of God are guidance and character-building. His attribute of Seeing restrains a person from doing wrong; His attribute of Hearing checks a person from using foul language; and His attribute of Knowing makes one afraid of plotting an evil against others. These names are not mere accidental titles; they are derived from God's attributes and have a real effect on man's conduct.

4. Mention three more attributes of God.

Three more attributes of God are: the Merciful (Al-Rahman), the Compassionate (Al-Rahim) and the Just (Al-Adl). Other attributes are the Creator, the Sustainer, the Forgiving and the All-Powerful.

5. How do these attributes help in refining the character of a person?

These attributes help in refining the character of a person by keeping him watchful over his deeds, words and thoughts. Remembering that God sees him stops him from sinning; remembering that God hears him stops him from foul talk; and remembering that God knows even his secret plans stops him from plotting evil. In this way the attributes of God become a constant guide, purifying a person's character day by day.

6. Do you think these attributes of God are remembered and kept in mind by us in our daily routine work?

No, I do not think that these attributes are properly remembered and kept in mind by us in our daily routine work. In the rush of daily life — in business, in studies and in conversation — most people forget that God sees, hears and knows everything. If we truly kept these attributes in mind, we would not cheat, abuse or plot against others. We should therefore make a habit of remembering them in every work we do, so that our daily life becomes honest and pure.

7. Make pairs of words similar in sound e.g. wait - weight. Words: end, scare, may, vain, lips, day, mere, talk, that, dare, bat, sheer, walk, crane, sips, bend.

The pairs of words similar in sound are: end — bend; scare — dare; may — day; lips — sips; mere — sheer; talk — walk; that — bat; vain — crane

(slant rhyme).

Poem 17: The Delight Song (N. Scott Momaday)

Exercise: Answer the following questions (Book p. 92)

1. What do you understand when the poet says, 'I am the shadow that follows a child'?

When the poet says, 'I am the shadow that follows a child,' I understand that he feels playful, light and innocent, like a child's shadow. A child's shadow follows lightly and carelessly, without any burden or worry. The poet means that he too moves through life lightly and joyfully, in complete harmony with the world, like a happy child at play.

2. How can the crust of the snow glitter?

The crust of the snow can glitter when sunlight falls on its frozen surface. The hard, icy crust reflects the sun's rays in many directions, so that it shines and sparkles like a cluster of bright beads. That is why the poet calls himself 'the glitter on the crust of the snow' — he is part of that shining beauty of nature.

3. What is the dream of the poet?

The dream of the poet is the whole dream of all the beautiful things he names: to be a feather on the bright sky, a blue horse running in the plain, a fish rolling shining in the water, a shadow following a child, the evening light, an eagle playing with the wind, a cluster of bright beads,

the farthest star, the cold of the dawn, the roaring of the rain, the glitter on the snow, the long track of the moon in a lake, and the flame of four colors. His dream is to be one with all these things — to live in complete harmony with nature.

4. What is the effect of man's good relation with the earth and the lords?

The effect of man's good relation with the earth and the lords is that he remains alive and active. The poet says, 'I stand in good relation to the earth, / I stand in good relation to the lords, / I stand in good relation to all that is beautiful, / I stand in good relation to all that is fruitful.' Because of these good relations, he is vivacious and full of life, and he can joyfully say, 'You see, I am alive, I am alive.'

5. What are the things that keep a person alive?

The things that keep a person alive are good relations: good relation with the earth, good relation with the lords, good relation with all that is beautiful, and good relation with all that is fruitful. Harmony with nature, with the atmosphere and with the universe keeps a person alive and active; it is this harmony, not wealth or power, that makes life delightful.

6. Pessimism and optimism are two attitudes of a human being. They describe the state of a person's mind who is hopeful at one moment and in despair at another. Can you tell which of these two attitudes goes well with this poem?

Optimism goes well with this poem. The poem is full of delight, life and hope: the poet feels light as a feather in the bright sky, finds no hurdles or difficulties anywhere in the universe, and is in complete harmony with everything. Again and again he declares, 'You see, I am alive, I am alive.'

There is no despair in the poem at all; it is a song of joy, and therefore it expresses the optimistic attitude.

7. Write down your opinion in a few sentences based on the theme of the poem.

In my opinion, the theme of the poem is true and beautiful: a person is really alive only when he lives in good relation with the earth, with others and with all that is beautiful and fruitful. Delight does not come from wealth or power, but from harmony with nature — from feeling oneself a part of the sky, the wind, the rain, the snow and the moon. The poem teaches us to be optimistic, playful and light-hearted, like a feather or a child's shadow, and to find joy in the simple wonders around us.

Poem 18: Love - an Essence of All Religions (Jalaluddin Rumi; translated by Dr. Nicholson)

Exercises (Book p. 94)

1. What is the effect of love?

The effect of love is that it changes all adversities into pleasures. Through love thorns become roses, vinegar becomes sweet wine, the stake becomes a throne, misfortune becomes good fortune, burning fire becomes pleasing light, stone becomes soft as butter, grief becomes a joy, lions become harmless, sickness becomes health, wrath seems to be a mercy, the dead rise to life, and the king becomes a slave. Love is the essence of all religions, and it transforms everything it touches.

2. Is life worth living without love?

No, life is not worth living without love. Life becomes a success and a pleasure only because of love; otherwise, as the Theme of the poem says, life is not worth living. Without love, thorns remain thorns, grief remains grief, and sickness remains sickness; it is love alone that turns them into roses, joy and health.

3. There are a number of antonyms in this poem. Write down the antonyms as given in the poem. Words: thorns, misfortune, stone, grief, sickness, wrath, dead, king.

The antonyms as given in the poem are: thorns — roses; misfortune — good fortune; stone — soft as butter (butter); grief — joy; sickness — health; wrath — mercy; dead — life; king — slave.

4. Make pairs of rhyming words from the list of words given below, e.g. fight-light. Words: roses, gone, health, fight, throne, poses, joy, wealth, light, toy, thorn, love, horn, dove.

The pairs of rhyming words are: roses — poses; health — wealth; fight — light; joy — toy; thorn — horn; love — dove; gone — throne (slant rhyme).

Poem 19: A Man of Words and Not of Deeds (Charles Perrault, 1628-1703; translated by Robert Samber)

Exercise: Answer the following questions (Book p. 96)

1. Paraphrase the poem.

A man who is all words and no deeds is like a garden full of weeds. When the weeds begin to grow, the garden becomes like a garden full of snow. When the snow begins to fall, it is like a bird sitting upon the wall. When the bird flies away, it is like an eagle in the sky. When the sky begins to roar, it is like a lion standing at the door. When the door begins to crack, it is like a stick struck across your back. When your back begins to smart with pain, it is like a penknife in your heart. And when your heart begins to bleed, you are dead and dead and dead indeed.

2. How does the life of man pass through different phases?

The life of man passes through different phases like the chain of images in the poem. It begins as a garden full of weeds — a life of useless talk. Then the weeds grow and the garden becomes cold and barren like snow in winter. Then comes a brief rest, like a bird upon the wall, followed by high flight like an eagle in the sky. Then danger comes, like a lion at the door, and punishment, like a stick across the back. Then pain, like a penknife in the heart, and finally the heart bleeds and life ends in death. Thus life passes from uselessness through danger and pain to its end.

3. What happens when life is spent with the help of words and not of deeds?

When life is spent with the help of words and not of deeds, it becomes useless like a garden full of weeds. The situation only grows worse, like snow in winter covering the garden, until pain and death follow. A man who only talks and boasts, and never does anything, wastes his life: his

words lead to nothing, his condition aggravates step by step, and in the end he is dead and dead and dead indeed.

4. What does the garden look like when the weeds start growing?

When the weeds start growing, the garden looks like a garden full of snow. Just as snow covers a garden and makes it cold, white and barren, so the growing weeds cover the garden and choke all useful plants. The garden loses its beauty and fruitfulness and becomes a cold, useless waste.

5. Write down all the rhyming words in the poem and use them in sentences of your own.

The rhyming words in the poem, used in sentences, are: (1) deeds — weeds: A man of words and not of deeds is like a garden full of weeds. (2) grow — snow: When the weeds begin to grow, the garden is covered with snow. (3) fall — wall: When the snow begins to fall, the bird sits upon the wall. (4) fly — sky: When the bird away does fly, it looks like an eagle in the sky. (5) roar — door: When the sky begins to roar, it is like a lion at the door. (6) crack — back: When the door begins to crack, it feels like a stick across your back. (7) smart — heart: When your back begins to smart, it feels like a penknife in your heart. (8) bleed — indeed: When your heart begins to bleed, you are dead and dead and dead indeed.

6. What is the moral of the poem?

The moral of the poem is that a man must engage himself in some fruitful activity, and not merely in talk and boasting. Words without deeds are like weeds in a garden: they choke all that is useful, and they lead step by step to ruin and death. Only deeds make life pleasant and useful

for humanity. A man should therefore do, and not merely say.

Poem 20: In Broken Images (Robert Graves)

Exercise: Answer the following questions (Book p. 98)

1. What is the state of two persons, one who trusts clear images and the other who mistrusts the broken images?

The person who trusts his clear images is quick but dull: he is quick in thinking because his images are clear, but he becomes dull because he trusts them without proof. He assumes their relevance and assumes the fact. The person who mistrusts his broken images is slow but sharp: he is slow because his images are broken, but he becomes sharp because he questions their relevance and questions the fact. Thus trust without inquiry makes a man dull, while doubt with inquiry makes him sharp.

2. Why does a person question his senses when the facts fail him?

A person questions his senses when the facts fail him because he had trusted his clear images completely and assumed the fact without questioning. When the fact fails, his whole trust collapses, and he has nothing left to blame except his own senses. He trusted his eyes and his mind blindly, so their failure leaves him doubting the very senses he relied upon.

3. Who is in a new confusion of his understanding?

'He' is in a new confusion of his understanding — the person who trusts

his clear images. Because he never questioned anything, when the fact fails him he is left in a fresh confusion: his understanding itself becomes confused. By contrast, the speaker, who mistrusted his broken images all along, is in a new understanding of his confusion — he understands that he is confused, which is itself a kind of wisdom.

4. What is the moral lesson of the poem?

The moral lesson of the poem is that nothing should be taken for granted, and that a person should remain inquisitive about the images of life, whether they are broken or clear. One who trusts his clear images without proof becomes dull in life, whereas one who mistrusts his broken images becomes sharp and intelligent. Inquiry into the nature of things leads one to understand and accept the ground realities of life. Doubt, used honestly, is better than blind certainty.

5. Rewrite the poem in past tense.

He was quick, thinking in clear images; / I was slow, thinking in broken images. / He became dull, trusting to his clear images; / I became sharp, mistrusting my broken images. / Trusting his images, he assumed their relevance; / Mistrusting my images, I questioned their relevance. / Assuming their relevance, he assumed the fact; / Questioning their relevance, I questioned the fact. / When the fact failed him, he questioned his senses; / When the fact failed me, I approved my senses. / He continued quick and dull in his clear images; / I continued slow and sharp in my broken images. / He in a new confusion of his understanding; / I in a new understanding of my confusion.

6. Paraphrase the first four lines of the poem in your own words.

The first four lines say: He (the other person) is quick because he thinks in clear images, while I (the poet) am slow because I think in broken images. He becomes dull because he trusts his clear images blindly, while I become sharp because I mistrust my broken images. In other words, clear and easy thinking makes a man quick but dull, while difficult, doubtful thinking makes a man slow but sharp.

7. What conclusion does the poet draw in the last two lines of the poem? Write in detail.

In the last two lines the poet draws the conclusion: 'He in a new confusion of his understanding; / I in a new understanding of my confusion.' The man who trusted his clear images ends in a new confusion of his understanding: because he never questioned anything, the failure of the fact leaves his very understanding confused. The poet, who mistrusted his broken images and questioned everything, ends in a new understanding of his confusion: he knows that he is confused, and that knowledge is itself understanding. The conclusion is that honest doubt leads to true wisdom, while blind certainty leads only to deeper confusion.